

UGNIUS MALAKAUSKAS

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PROFILE

Economics graduate with experience in econometrics, financial data analytics, and quantitative research in R, MATLAB, and Excel. Research interests include macroeconomics, monetary policy, asset management and international trade, alongside geopolitics and development economics. What draws me to this field is the desire to understand how the economic world works, as well as the opportunity for growth both professionally and intellectually. I am cooperative, innovative and flexible in different roles and conditions. I am looking for a job that allows me to deepen my knowledge, while contributing real value to the team.

EDUCATION

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam – Amsterdam, Netherlands 2025 – 2026

MSc Economics

- Relevant coursework: Advanced Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics, Econometrics, International Trade, Financial Economics, Time-Series Analysis.

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam – Amsterdam, Netherlands 2021 – 2025

BSc Philosophy, Politics and Economics

- Relevant coursework: Macroeconomics, Microeconomics, Data Analytics, Development Economics.

CERTIFICATIONS

Financial Management Specialization — University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Coursera) 2025

Financial Accounting, Investments, and Corporate Finance (6 courses)

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Master's Thesis Research, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam 2025 – 2026

Economic and Security Determinants of US Dollar Reserve Holdings — Grade: 8/10

- Constructed a panel dataset covering 22 reserve-holding economies from 2010 to 2025 by combining central-bank, financial-market, and geopolitical data.
- Estimated pooled OLS, country fixed-effects, and Mundlak correlated-random-effects models in R.
- Found that trade exposure to the US was the most consistent predictor of countries' dollar reserve shares.

Research Project Economics, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam Jan 2026 – March 2026

Long-Term Intergenerational Fairness under the Dutch Pension Reform — Grade: 7.0/10

- Critically synthesized four academic papers on the Netherlands' 2023 pension reform (Wtp) to assess whether its official fairness metric (netto-profijt) remains robust as the working-age population shrinks.
- Identified three distinct sources of instability (valuation sensitivity, rule-incidence sensitivity, and pool-size sensitivity), concluding that demographic shrinkage systematically shifts burden onto younger cohorts.

Recommendation Systems Project — Bright Cape Collaboration

Dec 2024 – March 2025

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam | Grade: 7.5/10

- Part of a four-person team building machine-learning recommendation engines (collaborative filtering, co-occurrence modeling) on a retail transaction dataset with 540,000 observations in R.
- Designed a rule-based classification system that categorized approximately 240,000 retail observations into 34 product categories used by the recommendation models.
- Developed a priority-weighted matching algorithm to resolve products spanning multiple category keywords.
- Validated categorization accuracy via F1 scoring across chronological and randomized data splits, while critically assessing results for signs of overfitting.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Albert Heijn – Amsterdam, Netherlands 2024 – 2025
Inventory Clerk

- Replenished and catalogued inventory across store sections, maintaining product availability.
- Coordinated with colleagues during high-volume shifts to complete stock management tasks.
- Maintained store presentation and quality standards by identifying misplaced and damaged products.

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

SOFTWARE PROFICIENCY

RStudio ● ● ● ● ○
MATLAB ● ● ● ○ ○
Microsoft Excel ● ● ● ● ●
Stata ● ● ● ○ ○
Python ● ● ○ ○ ○

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Lithuanian **Native**
English **C2**
Russian **B2**
Dutch **A2**

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Panel-data econometrics
Time-series analysis
Qualitative & quantitative research
Data analysis & interpretation
Statistical modelling
Cooperation
Adaptability